Brown - UWA presentation – 21.03.25

Title: Digital approaches to multilingual text analysis: the *Dictionnaire de la langue franque* and its morphology as hybrid data in the past

1. Mediterranean Lingua Franca: definition

The Mediterranean Lingua Franca (MLF) is (purportedly) an extinct trade language, with a Romance lexical base, used around the Mediterranean basin from anywhere between the late medieval to early modern period.

One of the most well-known documents which records MLF phenomena – the *Dictionnaire de la langue franque* of 1830, now held in the Bibliothèque Nationale de France.

2. Variation in MLF

Variety	Example(s)	Cited by
Arabic	*tarjuman* 'translator'	Aslanov (2014:126) Minervini (2010:802)
Catalan	*baschiar* 'to descend'	Cifoletti (1989:65)
Latinisms	*brakio* 'malt'	Cifoletti (1989:65)
Luso-Arabic	no example given	Aslanov (2014:131)
French	*biéra* 'beer'	Schuchardt (1909:41)
Greek	*aspra*[1] 'money'	Cifoletti (2004:42, n.1)
Italian	*piouma* 'feather'	Operstein (2017b:111)
Occitan	*gorba* 'basket'	Aslanov (2014:129)
Portuguese	*ficar* 'to remain'	Aslanov (2014: 125;131)
Provençal	*boulégar* 'to move' *cadiéra* 'chair'	Cifoletti (1989:65)
Spanish	*bentana* 'window'	Operstein (2017b:107)
Turkish	*pasa* 'Pasha'	Aslanov (2014:126) Minervini (2010:802)

[1] Cf. Cifoletti (2004:42, n.1): 'Reported by several other sources (Serrano, Tamayo, etc.), this is one of the few Greekisms in lingua franca' [Riportato da diverse altre fonti (Serrano, Tamayo ecc.) questo è uno dei pochi grecismi della lingua franca]. The transcription provided by Cifoletti on pp.57-75 provides no other cases of *grecismi*.

3. Textual evidencee for MLF: https://joshbrownwa.wixsite.com/mlfd

#	Year	Title	Author	Place	Genre
1	1204?	*Credo in latinike glotta*	anonymous	n/a	religious
2	1300	*Contrasto della Zerbitana*	anonymous	n/a	poem
3	1353	*Zerbitana Retica*	anonymous	Djerba	poem
4	c.1410	*Das Lied von der Kreuzfahrt*	Oswald von Wolkenstein	Eastern Mediterranean	poem
5	1484	*dialogue fragment*	Fabri	Alexandria	travel report
6	1520	*Villancico*	Encina	Holy Land	song
7	1528	*dialogue fragment in letter to pope*	Giovio	Djerba to Rome	letter
8	1545	*Zingana*	Giancarli	Rovigo	play
9	1581	*Matona mia cara*	Orlando di Lasso	Eastern Mediterranean	poem
10	1600	*The diary of Master Thomas Dallam*	Dallam	Rhodos	gentleman travel report
11	1612	*Topographia de Argel*	Haedo (ed.)	Algiers	slave travel report
12	1637	*Histoire de la Barbarie et de ses corsaires*	Pierre Dan	Barbary	redemptionist missionary travel report
13	1644	*Jesuit dialogue fragment*	P. Jose Tamayo	Algiers	prose fragment
14	1662	*Relation de la captivite et liberte du sieur Emanuel de Aranda, mene esclave a Alger en l'an 1640 et mis en liberte l'an 1642*	Emanuel de Aranda	Brussels	report
15	1664	*Voyage de la France Equinoxiale en l'isle Cayenne, entrepris par les Francois en l'annee MDCLII*	Antoine de Biet	Barbuda	travel report
16	1667	*Le sicilien*	Jean-Baptiste Poquelin de Moliere	Eastern Mediterranean	n/a
17	1670	*Dicionario des escritores trinitarios de Espana y Portugal, vol. IX*	Antonio de la Asuncion (1899)	Algiers	Word list
18	c.1670	*Libro en que se da razon del viaje que hicimos a la ciudad de Argel el ano de 1670*	Bartolome Serrano	Algiers	Word list
19	c.1675	*Histoire chronologique du Royaume de Tripoly*	anonymous		History
20	c.1683	*No title*	Otto Friedrich von der Groeben	Liberia	travel report
21	1697	*L'Europe galante*	M. de la Mothe	Eastern Mediterranean	n/a
22	1735	*Memoires du chevalier d'Arvieux*	Laurent d'Arvieux	Tunis	memoirs
23	1735	*La birba*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
24	1737	*Lugrezia Romana in Constantinopoli*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
25	1749	*La famiglia dell'antiquario*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
26	1751	*I pettegolezzi delle donne*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
27	1755	*Le donne de casa soa*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
28	1760	*L'impresario delle Smirne*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
29	1760	*La fiera di sinigaglia*	Goldoni, Carlo	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
30	1741	*El mercante Armeno*	Malamani, V	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
31	c.1740	*Un Turco inamora'*	Malamani, V	Eastern Mediterranean	literary
32	1760	*Account of an Algerine Corsair, on the Coast of Cornwall*	anonymous	Algiers	report
33	1789	*Reise in die Barbarey oder Briefe aus Alt-Numidien*	Jean L. M. Poiret	Barbary	travel report
34	1798-1800	*Nachrichten und Bemerkungen uber den algierschen Staat*	Anonymous	Algiers	travel report
35	1805	*Ragguaglio del viaggio compendioso di un dilettante antiquario sorpreso da corsari, condotto in Barberia e felicemente ripatriato*	Felice Caronni	Tunis	travel report
36	1817	*Avventure ed osservazioni sopra le coste di Barberia*	Filippo Pananti	Algiers	travel report
37	1822-1825	*MS in the Archivio del Consolato sardo, Tripoli*	Yusuf Qaramanli	Tripoli	n/a
38	1830	*Dictionnaire de la Langue Franque ou Petit Mauresque*	Anonymous	Algiers	dictionary
39	1830	*Gemalde von Algier*	M. Renaudot	Algiers	n/a
40	1834	*Notice sur Tunez et biographie du Bach Mamelouk Hassine. Revue de l'Histoire des Colonies Francaises*	Louis Calligaris	Tunis	report
41	1850	*Tunis: Description de cette Regence. L'univers Pictoresque*	Louis Frank	Tunis	travel report
42	1852	*La langue Sabir*	Anonymous	Algiers	report
43	1863	*Drei Jahre im Nordwesten von Afrika*	Heinrich Freiherr von Maltzan	Barbary coast	travel report
44	1870	*Schicksale und Wanderungen eines deutschen Renegaten in Nordafrika*	Heinrich Freiherr von Maltzan	Barbary coast	travel report
45	1882	*Letter to Hugo Schuchardt*	Emil Jellinek	Barbary coast	letter
46	1884	*L'alliance francaise pour la propagation de la langue francaise dans les colonies et les pays etrangers*	L. Faidherbe	Algiers	general
47	1884	*Review of Faidherbe*	Victor Waille	Algiers	review article
48	1887	*L'Algerie qui s'en va*	Bernard	Algiers	travel report
49	1887	*Voyage dans le sud de la Tunisie*	Valerie Mayet	Tunisia	travel report

4. Hathi Trust…

… is a large-scale collaborative repository of digital content from research libraries including content digitized via Google Books and the Internet Archive, as well as content digitized locally by libraries.

5. Digital approaches to MLF

5.1 NLTK (Natural Language Toolkit), Stemmers (Snowball)

Some simple things you can do with NLTK

Tokenize and tag some text:

```
>>> import nltk
>>> sentence = """At eight o'clock on Thursday morning
... Arthur didn't feel very good."""
>>> tokens = nltk.word_tokenize(sentence)
>>> tokens
['At', 'eight', "o'clock", 'on', 'Thursday', 'morning',
'Arthur', 'did', "n't", 'feel', 'very', 'good', '.']
>>> tagged = nltk.pos_tag(tokens)
>>> tagged[0:6]
[('At', 'IN'), ('eight', 'CD'), ("o'clock", 'JJ'), ('on', 'IN'),
('Thursday', 'NNP'), ('morning', 'NN')]
```

Identify named entities:

```
>>> entities = nltk.chunk.ne_chunk(tagged)
>>> entities
Tree('S', [('At', 'IN'), ('eight', 'CD'), ("o'clock", 'JJ'),
           ('on', 'IN'), ('Thursday', 'NNP'), ('morning', 'NN'),
       Tree('PERSON', [('Arthur', 'NNP')]),
           ('did', 'VBD'), ("n't", 'RB'), ('feel', 'VB'),
           ('very', 'RB'), ('good', 'JJ'), ('.', '.')])
```

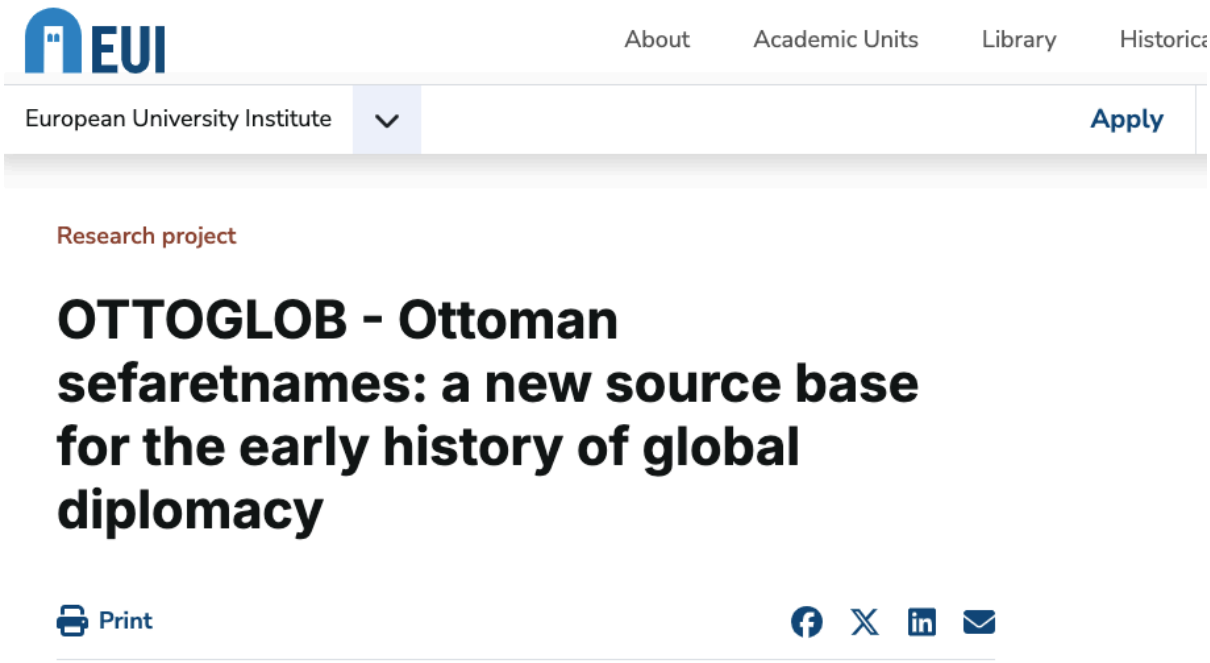
5.2 SVG (Scalar Vector Graphing) and palaeography

Tracing
Visualization

5.3 Mapping

6. Planned future work: new research questions

6.1 Over which geographical area was MLF used and how does its glottonym perpetuate the false myth of standard language ideology in historical sociolinguistics?

6.2 How can digital tools help us discern evidence of MLF in the past? Are tools from ML sufficiently developed to deal with mixed-language phenomena?

6.3 What, if any, is the role of lingua francas in the practice of European correspondence around the Mediterranean basis in the Late Medieval and Early Modern period? How can it help us to decentre Eurocentrism?